

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Transformation Leader | Company-Wide AI Adoption, Process Redesign, and Governance

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PROFILE

Most AI investments fail at adoption rather than at technology. For fifteen years I got people to change how they work when none of them reported to me, inside a business where Risk and Compliance could stop anything I built. At TIAA (\$1.5T AUM) I conceived an AI-powered career development platform, led the team that built it, and owned it from use-case scoping through governance, rollout, and measurement. I built one adoption operating model and carried it across seven business areas whose leaders did not report to me. I also conceived and shipped two agentic AI products that are live in production, so I know what it takes to get an agent working rather than onto a roadmap. I am not the engineer, and the things I have shipped are the reason I do not need to be.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

May 2011 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

Director, Business Management (2022-2026) | Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Change Across Functions That Did Not Report to Me

- **One adoption operating model across seven business areas, none of whose leaders reported to me.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and moved each from pilot to a sustained way of working. Enablement, acceptable-use standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept ownership of its own use cases. I set the operating rhythm, the prioritization, and the resource calls. The design was never the hard part. Getting seven leaders to give up their own version of the work was.
- **700 people absorbed a smaller building without a retention crisis.** Corporate Real Estate set the target and I directed the execution, moving 700 associates from assigned seating into a hoteling model and giving back five floors, roughly 44 percent of the square footage, while the work kept running without a retention crisis. I then managed the Frisco Corporate Center transition for 500+ associates. The number was the plan. Getting people to live inside it afterward was the job.

AI From Use Case to Company-Wide Rollout

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, governance, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 16,000+ associates had access to it and I reached 1,500+ directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching, because you cannot send an email and call it adoption.
- **Reported results in numbers a chief executive could act on.** I defined the success measures, tracked them, and carried them to senior leaders through executive read-outs, business cases, and quarterly business reviews. Adoption was measured by active usage, never by headcount with access. I built and negotiated a \$300K annual engagement budget with Finance inside roughly \$500K of program spend I administered, then showed what it bought.

Governance That Let AI Ship Rather Than Stopping It

- **Set the hard limits, in that order.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII entered the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts and human oversight that keep a person in control of the decision.
- **Found the permission exposure the AI work was sitting on.** I owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 files flagged for PII with IT. An assistant surfaces to a person everything

they already have permission to reach, so permission sprawl is a day-one exposure rather than a later phase.

- **Graded vendors when the money was real.** I held a seat on the corporate team that selected an enterprise platform, helping write the RFP and grading every proposal and finalist presentation. That was not an AI purchase and I do not present it as one. The discipline transfers.

AGENTIC AI I CONCEIVED AND SHIPPED

- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily, not a demo.** Each agent holds a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. The gates have caught overclaims on their way into live work. They have also missed one. I published the methodology behind this practice in 2026. This is the repeatable agent playbook I actually run.
- **Two live products.** CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), where I conceived an 11-module journey, a four-agent AI interview simulator, and an applicant CRM, and directed the build. Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), where I designed the 5-stage framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made them real. Both are live and not yet opened to the public.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **Sat on the sales side of enterprise recruiting-technology deals.** Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions. I was the engineer on the sales team rather than the closer and built what the reps used to win, scoping capability needs and shaping multi-year implementation plans for Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, and Regions Bank. I directed enhancements to recruiting solutions deployed for clients including Extra Space Storage, a multi-site operator hiring hourly at volume. I know what buyers of this software actually pay for, because I was across the table from them.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI Transformation and Operating Model: Enterprise AI Roadmap | Use-Case Intake, Assessment and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Business Process Redesign | Adoption KPIs and Value Realization | Champion Networks and Communities of Practice | AI Literacy and Capability Building | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Hands-on across Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, ChatGPT, Amazon Q Developer

Governance and Risk Partnership: Responsible AI Governance and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Data Privacy Remediation | Vendor Selection and RFP Scoring | Change Management

Enterprise and Executive: Executive Read-Outs and Business Cases | Budget Built and Negotiated (\$300K) | Cross-Functional Leadership Without Line Authority | Enterprise Software Delivery | Microsoft 365 and SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA